PR BEYOND THE BASICS

By / Rimas Sirag Eldin



When you hear PR, what is the first thing that comes to mind?

What Makes Someone Good at PR?

01 **Having a large network?**

02 **Being a good communicator?**

03 **Closing successful deals?**

04 **Building relationships that last?**





? **Which one do you think matters most in PR?**

RECAP:
SPONSOR VS PARTNER VS CSR



SPONSOR



PARTNER



CSR

? **Can you explain the difference between these three in one sentence?**

KEY DIFFERENCE:

1. SPONSORSHIP

Financial or in-kind support provided in exchange for agreed promotional or other benefits.

2. PARTNERSHIP

A collaborative relationship between two parties working toward shared goals and mutual value.

3. CSR – CORPORATE SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

A company's responsibility to consider its social and environmental impact and contribute positively to society.

Key Difference: Sponsorship focuses on support and agreed benefits; partnership focuses on collaboration and shared goals; CSR focuses on responsible business practices and positive social or environmental impact.

Remember: A company can be a sponsor, a partner, and a CSR contributor in different contexts.

TYPES OF SPONSORSHIP

Financial Sponsorship

In-Kind Sponsorship

Media Sponsorship

Venue Sponsorship

Service Sponsorship



? **A company provides the venue instead of money. What type of sponsorship is this?**



TYPES OF CORPORATE SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY (CSR)



ENVIRONMENTAL RESPONSIBILITY



ETHICAL RESPONSIBILITY



PHILANTHROPIC RESPONSIBILITY



ECONOMIC RESPONSIBILITY



COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

? **A business organizes a recycling initiative to reduce community waste. Which CSR type is this?**

IDENTIFY THE TYPE

Challenge:classifyeachscenariobefore revealing the answers.



1. A printing company provides 500 flyers for an event.
2. A company funds a workshop in exchange for agreed brand exposure.
3. A business organizes a recycling initiative to reduce community waste.
4. A media platform promotes an event through its channels.
5. A company and Enactus jointly design and deliver a training program.

? TAKE 20 SECONDS: WHAT TYPE OF SUPPORT OR RELATIONSHIP IS DESCRIBED IN EACH SCENARIO?



ANSWERS

1. Aprintingcompany provides 500 flyers for an event.
2. A company funds a workshop in exchange for agreed brand exposure.
3. A business organizes a recycling initiative to reduce community waste.
4. A media platform promotes an event through its channels.
5. A company and Enactus jointly design and deliver a training program.

IN-KIND / SERVICE SPONSORSHIP

FINANCIAL SPONSORSHIP

ENVIRONMENTAL CSR

MEDIA SPONSORSHIP

PARTNERSHIP

UNDERSTANDING BUSINESS NEEDS

THINK LIKE A BUSINESS

- What are its current goals?
- Who is its target audience?
- What challenges might it be facing?
- What value could a collaboration with Enactus create?



CORE PRINCIPLE: SUCCESSFUL OUTREACH STARTS WITH UNDERSTANDING, NOT ASKING.

? **Before contacting a company, what should you investigate first?**

THE BUSINESS NEEDS FRAMEWORK

5 AREAS TO INVESTIGATE

BRAND AWARENESS

Does the business want more people to know its brand?

CUSTOMER ACQUISITION

Is it trying to reach new customers?

AUDIENCE ACCESS

Does it want to connect with a specific audience?

EMPLOYER BRANDING

Does it want to attract young talent?

SOCIAL IMPACT

Does it have community or sustainability goals?

RESEARCH BEFORE YOU REACH OUT. NEVER ASSUME.

? **Which of these five areas might be relevant to a business you want to contact?**

BUILDING A STRONG VALUE PROPOSITION

VALUE PROPOSITION Aclear statement explaining why a business should consider working with us and what relevant value the collaboration may create.

A Strong Value Proposition Is:

- Relevant to the business.
- Clear and specific.
- Credible and realistic.
- Connected to measurable or observable outcomes.

Don't Just List Benefits. Explain Their Value.

? **Is listing benefits enough?**



THE VALUE PROPOSITION FORMULA

The Formula

Business Goal + **Relevant Opportunity** + **Credible Evidence** = **Strong Value Proposition**

EXAMPLE

"Your brand can connect with university students through our event, with visibility opportunities tailored to the agreed audience and deliverables."

EVIDENCE MATTERS:

- Verified audiencedata.
- Clear deliverables.
- Realistic reach estimates.
- Previous results, when available.



Never promise outcomes you cannot support.

? **What is missing when a proposal makes promises without credible evidence?**

STRATEGIC OUTREACH & RELATIONSHIP BUILDING

THE STRATEGIC OUTREACH PROCESS

A 6-STEP OUTREACH PROCESS

1. Researchthe business.
2. Identify the relevant contact person.
3. Define your objective.
4. Personalize your message.
5. Propose a relevant next step.
6. Follow up professionally.

The Goal of the First Message: Start a relevant conversation, not explain everything at once.

PERSONALIZATION & FOLLOW-UP

PERSONALIZATION

SHOWTHATYOUUNDERSTAND SOMETHING RELEVANT ABOUT THE BUSINESS AND EXPLAIN WHY YOU ARE REACHING OUT SPECIFICALLY TO THEM.

PROFESSIONAL FOLLOW-UP

- Refer to yourprevious message.
- Keep the message brief and polite.
- Add context or useful information when possible.
- Respect their response and communication preferences.

? What is the goal of the first message?

OBJECTION HANDLING & NEGOTIATION



UNDERSTAND THE OBJECTION BEFORE RESPONDING

COMMON BUSINESS OBJECTIONS

- "We don't have a budget."
- "We don't see how this benefits us."
- "We already work with another organization."
- "Your requested support is too much."
- "We are not interested at the moment."

THE 3-STEP RESPONSE FRAMEWORK

1. Listen without interrupting.
2. Clarify the underlying concern.
3. Respond with a relevant and realistic option.

Never treat every objection as a rejection.

? A company says, "We don't have a budget." What should your first step be?

NEGOTIATION: CREATE MUTUAL VALUE

NEGOTIATION PRINCIPLES

- Understand the other party's priorities.
- Know what we can and cannot offer.
- Separate essential needs from flexible terms.
- Explore alternatives before rejecting a proposal.
- Confirm every agreed deliverable clearly.

BEFORE NEGOTIATING, DEFINE

- Our objective.
- Our minimum acceptable outcome.
- What we can offer.
- What we can adjust.
- What requires approval.

A successful negotiation protects the relationship and delivers a realistic agreement.

? **If the other party rejects your first proposal, should you immediately reject theirs?**

When to CONTINUE, ADAPT, or Walk Away



? **Should we accept every deal just to achieve our target?**

WHEN TO CONTINUE, ADAPT, OR WALK AWAY

CONTINUE	Continue when there is clear interest and a realistic path forward.
ADAPT	Adapt when the goal is shared but the proposed terms need adjustment.
PAUSE	Pause when the timing or decision-making process is unclear.
WALK AWAY PROFESSIONALLY	Walk Away Professionally when expectations are unrealistic, commitments cannot be fulfilled, or the agreement conflicts with our values and responsibilities.

Remember: Not every deal is a good deal.

? **The goal is shared, but the proposed terms need adjustment. What should you do?**

CLOSING: BEYOND THE BASICS: THINK DIFFERENTLY

- ✓ Don't approachabusinessbeforeunderstanding it.
- ✓ Don't offer benefits without understanding their value.
- ✓ Don't treat every objection as a rejection.
- ✓ Don't close a deal at the expense of a good relationship.
- ✓ Don't measure success only by the number of deals.

Research with purpose. Communicate with value. Negotiate with integrity. Build relationships that last.

? What is one thing you will do differently in your next outreach?

Thank You!

QUESTIONS?



